

FMAM 2026 rainfall outlook

ECMWF SEAS5 initialized 1 February 2026 · calibrated with CHIRPS v2.0 · FMAM R2 (Belg) rainfall domain

Research reconstruction — not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast

The forecast leans toward above normal rainfall in the FMAM R2 (Belg) rainfall domain: averaged over the area, the local probability of above normal is 39%, against about 33% for climatology. Mean forecast rainfall is 235 mm against a 1993–2025 average of 213 mm (+22 mm, +11%).



Below normal 26% Near normal 35% Above normal 39%

Average local probability: each grid cell has its own tercile probabilities; these are their averages over the 100% of the area that has probabilities, not the probability that the area-total rainfall falls in a category.

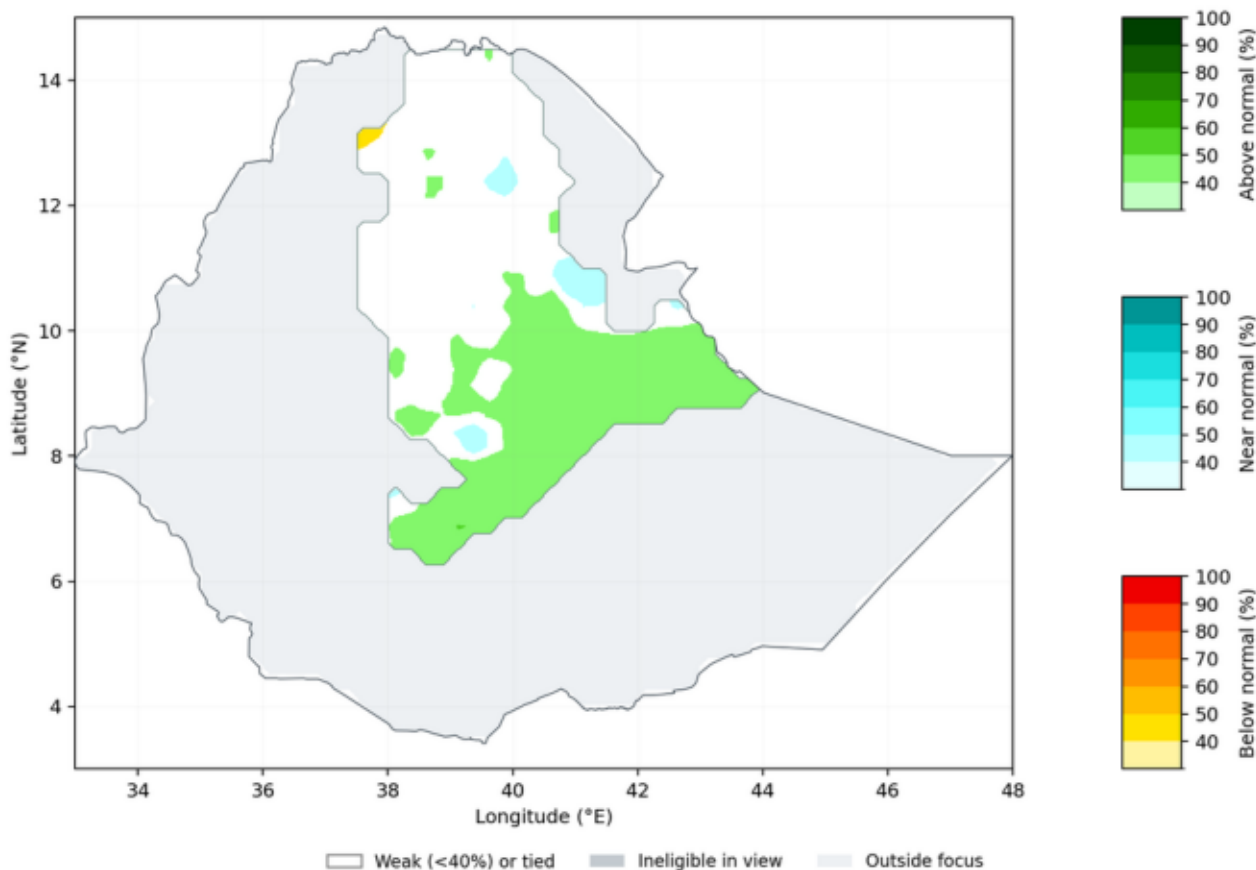
Forecast signal: Weak tilt toward above normal (largest area-average probability compared with a one-third reference; based on probabilities only).

Historical skill (FMAM R2 (Belg) rainfall domain): Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain. Probability skill (RPSS) +0.040, cross-validated 1993–2016, 95% interval -0.049 to $+0.114$; better than climatology in 16 of 24 years. A strong signal is not a confidence rating.

FMAM 2026 | rainfall tercile outlook

February initialization · shared probability blend · CHIRPS reference 1993–2025

FMAM R2 (Belg) rainfall domain · presentation layer



Display interpolation: 12x; Gaussian $\sigma=0.6$ native cells. Statistics and exported fields use the original 0.25° grid.
Research reconstruction of a February-initialized forecast; not an official EMI/ICPAC product.

All targets, evidence and record

FMAM 2026 — February initialization · FMAM R2 (Belg) rainfall domain

Target	Below/near/above	Coverage	Anomaly	Verification status
FMAM 2026	26% / 35% / 39%	100%	+22 mm	Awaiting CHIRPS: Feb 2026 file not found (checked 9 Oct 2026)
Feb 2026	37% / 39% / 24%	95%	−4 mm	Awaiting CHIRPS: Feb 2026 file not found (checked 9 Oct 2026)
Mar 2026	33% / 34% / 33%	100%	+2 mm	Verification published
Apr 2026	31% / 28% / 42%	100%	+19 mm	Verification published
May 2026	32% / 35% / 32%	100%	+3 mm	Verification published

Historical skill, cross-validated (probability skill, RPSS, with whole-year 95% interval)

Target	RPSS (95% interval)	Yrs better	Holm p	In words
FMAM	+0.040 (−0.049 to +0.114)	16/24	0.717	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain
Feb	+0.156 (+0.048 to +0.264)	19/24	0.024	Moderate improvement over climatology (interval above zero)
Mar	+0.023 (−0.026 to +0.065)	16/24	0.717	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain
Apr	+0.001 (−0.061 to +0.054)	14/24	0.857	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain
May	+0.006 (−0.063 to +0.066)	17/24	0.857	Small estimated improvement; skill uncertain

Verification against CHIRPS (single season or month)

Target	RPSS	CRPSS	Bias	Forecast / observed anomaly	Observed below/near/above
Mar 2026	+0.007	+0.048	−41.4 mm	+2 / +44 mm	0% / 8% / 92%
Apr 2026	−0.101	−0.454	+28.1 mm	+19 / −9 mm	42% / 27% / 30%
May 2026	+0.048	+0.021	+10.9 mm	+3 / −8 mm	28% / 63% / 9%

Cycle record

Model initialization: 1 February 2026 · ECMWF SEAS5 (system 51), 51 members

Target period: 1 Feb 2026 – 31 May 2026

Forecast record: Frozen 9 Oct 2026 (after the target period ended, before this project downloaded its observations; SHA-256 manifest)

Publication status: Research reconstruction: produced after the initialization date with the published method; not an official EMI or ICPAC forecast

Reference period: CHIRPS v2.0 FMAM 1993-2025 (33 seasons)

Observations processed through: May 2026 (Mar, Apr, May)

CHIRPS archive: Official CHIRPS v2.0 p25 by_month listing checked 9 Oct 2026: monthly files through Aug 2026; Feb 2026 file not found

Verification last run: 9 Oct 2026

Method / version: Shared climatology blend ($\lambda = 0.44$ for FMAM) · code 3b8a55d

How to read: terciles split the reference-period rainfall into three equally likely parts. Climatology assigns about one-third to each (the observed tercile frequencies of the training years). Skill scores are decimals: +0.05 means a 5% lower score than climatology. RPSS refers to the blended probabilities; CRPSS and bias to the amount-corrected ensemble.

Limitations: few evaluation years and single verification seasons give wide uncertainty; the 0.25° maps repeat ~1° model information; the rainfall domain is for display and summaries only.

Monthly tercile outlooks

FMAM 2026 — February initialization · FMAM R2 (Belg) rainfall domain

